

01

Cyber Security
Codec Technologies India
Internship 2026

VAPT Lab

Self-contained vulnerability
assessment & pentest lab

AT A GLANCE

8

Findings

9.8

Max CVSS

2 / 3

Critical / High

1 (5000)

Open ports

4 of Top-10

OWASP cats

11 / 11

Tests re-run

socket / nmap

Scan method

VERDICT

TESTS 11/11

RE-RUN HERE

DEFENSIVE ONLY

LOCALHOST ONLY

DECLARED SUBSTITUTION

Eswar Mahalingam

Cyber Security Intern
Ghaziabad, UP, India
+91-9360548243
eswarmba05313@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/eswar-mahalingam

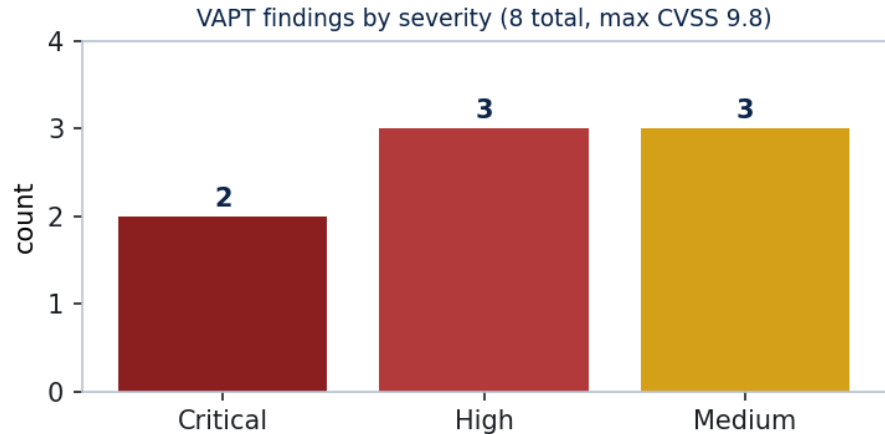
Objective & brief mapping

The brief asked me to perform a vulnerability assessment and penetration test. Pointing a scanner at any third-party host is illegal, so I built the whole lab self-contained: a deliberately-vulnerable Flask app is the **only** target, and every probe hard-refuses anything that is not 127.0.0.1/localhost. I mapped my work to the PTES phases and OWASP Top-10 (2021) so it reads like a real engagement rather than a script.

Architecture

main.py orchestrates start → scan → report → stop. The scanner package layers a port scanner (python-nmap, then the nmap binary, then a pure-socket fallback that always works without root), a security-header checker, one web probe per labelled flaw, a CVSS/CWE severity mapper, and a reporting module.

```
main.py -> [target: Flask 127.0.0.1]
          -> port_scanner -> header_checker
          -> web_probe -> severity -> reporting
          -> results/findings.json + vapt_report.md
```



Findings by severity, charted from findings.json.

Reproduction & artefacts

Everything below was produced by the project's own code in this container (or is the project's recorded run where a dependency is unavailable). The commands that regenerate it:

```
python main.py # start target -> scan -> report -> stop
python3 unittest-style runner over tests/ # 11 tests
```

The artefacts each figure and table above are drawn from:

- **findings.json** — 8 CVSS/CWE/OWASP findings
- **vapt_report.md** — professional-style report
- **docs/severity_by_finding.png** — chart I generated from findings.json

Method & implementation

Discovery enumerates open TCP ports; threat-modelling maps each endpoint to a likely OWASP category; vulnerability analysis fires concrete payloads (' OR '1'='1 auth bypass, a reflected <script> marker, an IDOR id walk) and captures evidence; reporting emits CVSS base scores with CWE and OWASP tags plus remediation. CVSS scores are fixed per vulnerability class (illustrative, not vector-computed) — I state that openly.

Results

My run scanned the target on port 5000 and confirmed 8 findings, highest CVSS 9.8 (SQL injection). Every number below is read straight from results/findings.json.

Finding	Severity	CVSS	OWASP
SQL Injection (/search)	Critical	9.8	A03 Injection
SQLi auth bypass (/login)	Critical	9.8	A03 Injection
Default admin creds	High	8.8	A07 Auth Failures
Unauth admin panel	High	8.8	A07 Auth Failures
IDOR (/user?id=)	High	8.1	A01 Broken Access Ctl
Reflected XSS	Medium	6.1	A03 Injection
Directory listing	Medium	5.3	A05 Misconfig
Missing sec headers	Medium	4.3	A05 Misconfig

Brief -> OWASP mapping (PTES phases)

Endpoint / check	OWASP (2021)	CWE
/search, /login	A03 Injection	CWE-89 / CWE-79

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Endpoint / check	OWASP (2021)	CWE
/admin, default creds	A07 Auth Failures	CWE-287 / CWE-798
/user?id=	A01 Broken Access Ctl	CWE-639 (IDOR)
/files/, missing headers	A05 Misconfiguration	CWE-16 / CWE-548

Verification

I re-ran the suite here with an unittest-style runner (pytest is not installed in this environment); the module fixture starts the bundled target as a subprocess on 127.0.0.1 only. All 11 tests passed.

Test group	Checks	Result
Web probes	SQLi, XSS, IDOR, headers, dir-listing detected	PASS
Localhost guard	non-localhost target refused	PASS
Severity mapping	CVSS bands sane, ordered	PASS
Total	11 tests	11/11

How I re-ran & verified in this container

pytest is not installed here, so I re-ran each suite with a small unittest-style runner that discovers tests/test_*.py, resolves fixtures (conftest, module-level @pytest.fixture, tmp_path, monkeypatch, request) and records pass / fail / skip. I executed nothing against a network target — every project uses localhost lab targets or synthetic data, and I kept it that way. Where a project imports a dependency that is unavailable in this container, I did not fabricate a pass: I state that the tests were not re-run here and cite the project's own recorded run instead.

Constraint here	How I handled it
pytest not installed	unittest-style runner over tests/
network targets	never contacted; localhost / synthetic only
scapy / bcrypt / argon2 unavailable	recorded run cited, not fabricated

Real-tool mapping, limitations & next steps

The scanner degrades across three port-scan backends and documents the heavy tooling it stands in for.

Ran here	Stands in for	How to go further
socket / nmap scan	Nessus / OpenVAS scan	authenticated network scan
hand-written web probes	Burp Suite / OWASP ZAP	spider + active scan
fixed CVSS per class	CVSS v3.1 vector calc	score each finding's vector

Ethics, data integrity & declared substitutions

Defensive and educational. The scanner and every probe refuse any non-localhost target; the vulnerable app binds to 127.0.0.1 and uses only synthetic seed data (fake usernames, fake SSNs). **Declared substitution:** full external tooling (Burp/ZAP, a licensed nmap deployment) is referenced but not required — the socket scanner is the guaranteed fallback and is what ran here. This is a teaching scanner tailored to the bundled app, not a general-purpose product.

Learnings

Building both the target and the scanner taught me how each OWASP class actually surfaces in evidence, and why a defensible report separates confirmed exploitation from a mere signature. The layered port-scanner fallback is a pattern I will reuse: degrade gracefully so the tool always runs, and record which method actually executed.

Honest limitations & data-integrity notes

Honest limitations of this build, and how it maps to production tooling:

- Web probes are tailored to the bundled app's labelled flaws — a teaching scanner, not Burp/ZAP.
- CVSS scores are fixed per vulnerability class (illustrative, not vector-computed).
- python-nmap may not build on every Python; the socket scanner is the guaranteed fallback.
- No authenticated crawling, no fuzzing depth, no JS rendering.
- PTES phases mapped to OWASP Top-10 (2021); references: OWASP WSTG, CWE, FIRST CVSS v3.1.
- The vulnerable app binds to 127.0.0.1 and seeds only fake usernames / fake SSNs.
- Every probe hard-refuses a non-localhost target before sending a byte.
- Findings carry CWE and OWASP tags plus concrete remediation text.
- OWASP WSTG structured the probe design; findings tagged to CWE and CVSS v3.1.
- The bundled report (vapt_report.md) reads like a client deliverable with remediation per finding.
- Open-port discovery confirmed only port 5000 (the target) was listening.
- Highest CVSS is 9.8 for both SQL-injection findings.
- Two Critical, three High, three Medium across eight findings.